

You said it...



I recently read the article 'How to Crack Job Interviews' in the October issue of LFY. While the article addresses the subject admirably, we need to also address the question of skill deficiency. It is a well-known fact that only about 10 per cent of job aspirants get through the interviews. The selected few generally go through a training program, which polishes their IT skills and improves their soft skills. The main focus of these training programmes is 'learning by doing'. The other 90 per cent do not make it because they lack IT skills, and many lack soft skills too. There is a need to address the issue of the inadequate IT skills of our graduates. Linux can play an important role in this area.

With hardware prices falling, a laptop or a desktop is within the reach of many students. Install any standard Linux distribution, and you get a full-fledged system with many compilers, libraries, tools, etc. From then onwards, depending on an individual's interest, any type of programming can be learnt. In fact, the choice is so huge, it can be very overwhelming! If one is interested in traditional languages, C and C++ are available. If one is interested in functional programming, 'SCHEME', 'HASKELL', and 'ERLANG' are available. If your interest is in Web development, the usual LAMP stack is available. However, for programmers who are beginners, I would recommend Python as a starting language, since it has a simple syntax and excellent support in terms of libraries.

Often, I have heard students saying that they don't have problems to solve, which is unfortunate, because there are many good repositories freely available on the Internet. Here are a few sites I know of:

- projecteuler.net
- www.inf.bme.hu/contests/tasks
- www.karrels.org/Ed/ACM
- uva.onlinejudge.org

So, in conclusion, I would like to see Linux being used, more and more, as a learning tool, in addition to being used for many other purposes.

—**Lalitha K Prasad** [lalitha.prasad@tcs.com], head, Corporate Learning Centre, Tata Consultancy Services



I am an associate professor in medicine at a medical college. I discovered Linux two-three years back and now try to follow and support OSS/Linux in every way possible. I have converted around 12 doctors into Linux users and fans. I had been seeking some advice on an Android phone since October last year. Please accept my heartiest congratulations on your story, 'Android Experience' (in the November 2009 issue). However, I do feel that comparing HTC Tattoo (www.htc.com/www/product/tattoo/overview.html) with HTC Hero would have served readers better. HTC Tattoo would have satisfied more readers and buyers than HTC Hero, with its bloated price tag. We now await reviews on affordable Android phones!

—**Dr Smit Shrivastava, dr.smit.shrivastava@gmail.com**

The author, Sayantan Pal, replies:
First and foremost, I would like to express my elation for your kind words. About the comparison between HTC Hero and HTC Tattoo, the Hero was launched in the first week of September 2009, in India, while HTC Tattoo was launched in India on November 18 (despite being launched in European countries in the first week of September itself). It was because of the timing of the

Indian launch that we couldn't come up with a comparative review.



I am a regular reader of *LINUX For You* and am very impressed by its contents and presentation. Nagios seems to be a good system and network monitoring software. I have tried it many times but I do not know how to use it effectively. Could you please help system administrators like me by publishing an article on how to install and use Nagios?

—**S Chinnachamy, chinnachamy.s@gmail.com**

ED: We've covered Nagios in depth back in December 2007... Hope that article (sent to you as a PDF) has helped you to get started.



I am eagerly awaiting the December issue of *LINUX For You* hoping it will come bundled with Mandriva 2010. Because of low bandwidth, it is very difficult to download a 4 GB operating system. The best way to get it is through your magazine; so please include Mandriva 2010 in your next issue.

—**Niranjana Adiga, nvadiga@yahoo.co.in**

ED: Well, as you can see, the December 2010 issue has come with Mandriva 2010. And what's more, there's Ubuntu 9.10 and openSUSE 11.2 as well :-)

Please send your comments or suggestions to:

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